Murray cod

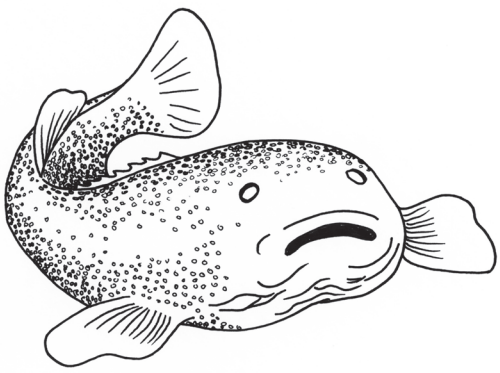
☞ **1** Read the notes below about the **declining population** of the Murray cod, then write a paragraph summarising the reasons for its decline.

- live in the waters of the Murray-Darling Basin
- are **territorial**, aggressive and live under submerged logs
- mature at approximately 5 years or 50 cm long
- can grow to over 1 metre and live for over 70 years
- **spawn** in warm waters
- are highly prized by fishermen
- population is in decline due to overfishing, clearing of submerged logs and drought periods that shrink waterholes, leading to greater competition for food and habitat
- dams, levees and irrigation limit species movement, which in turn limits **genetic diversity** at spawning due to in-breeding
- cold water released from dams prevents spawning

2 To help maintain population numbers, scientists have bred Murray cod in **hatcheries** and released them into the wild. There is also a minimum catch size of 50 cm long. Both of these strategies have had limited success. Why do you think this is?

3 List the factors that increase and decrease numbers in the Murray cod population.

Numbers increase	Numbers decrease



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